

Driver Qualification File · index

For **John Doe** · Acme Trucking LLC · the 12 documents §391.51 requires

§391.51 says every motor carrier "shall maintain a driver qualification file for each driver it employs." Below is the master index. Missing any single item is a citation. Missing patterns across multiple drivers is an unsatisfactory safety rating.

I · THE 12 REQUIRED DOCUMENTS

#	DOCUMENT	CFR	RETENTION
1	Driver's application for employment (full §391.21 long-form)	§391.21	Duration of employment + 3 yr
2	Initial state MVR (within 30 days of hire)	§391.23(a)(1)	Duration + 3 yr
3	Previous employer safety performance history inquiries (DOT employment + D&A · 3 years back)	§391.23(d)	Duration + 3 yr
4	Road test certificate OR equivalent (CDL on file with proper class/endorsements)	§391.31 / §391.33	Duration + 3 yr
5	Medical examiner's certificate (current · max 24 mo)	§391.43	Current + 3 yr after replacement
6	National Registry verification (NRCME ID + date verified)	§391.23(m)	Duration + 3 yr
7	Annual driver's review of driving record (§391.25 review note)	§391.25(c)	Duration + 3 yr
8	Annual list of violations (driver self-cert per §391.27) OR annual MVR substitute	§391.27	Duration + 3 yr
9	Annual MVR (one per year for every state where licensed in last 12 mo)	§391.25(a)	Duration + 3 yr
10	Clearinghouse pre-employment full query + driver consent	§382.701(a)	3 yr
11	Clearinghouse annual limited query consent (general written) + each query result	§382.701(b)	3 yr

#	DOCUMENT	CFR	RETENTION
12	Entry-level driver training certificate (for new CDL holders post 02/07/2022)	§380.609	Duration + 3 yr

II · WHEN EACH ANNUAL TASK FIRES

- **Annual MVR** · pull one full state MVR every 12 months for every state where the driver was licensed in the past year
- **Annual driver's review** · supervisor sits with the driver, reviews the MVR + safety performance, signs a §391.25(c) note
- **Annual list of violations** · driver self-certifies all moving violations from the past 12 months on a §391.27 form
- **Annual limited Clearinghouse query** · one per driver per year (already has driver's general consent on file)

III · COMMON AUDIT FINDINGS (THE GOTCHAS)

1. **Medical card expired** · driver is still driving · this is an immediate out-of-service for the driver and a citation for you
2. **No National Registry verification** · the medical card alone isn't enough · §391.23(m) requires you verify the examiner is registered + record the date you did so
3. **Missing previous-employer inquiries** · you must contact each DOT employer from the past 3 years for safety performance + D&A history · keep the actual responses, not just an attempt log
4. **Annual review skipped** · easy to fall behind on · most fleets get cited here
5. **No ELDT certificate** · for drivers who got their CDL after 02/07/2022 · this lives in the public registry, but you still need a copy in the DQ file

The X3 Compass DQ tracker pulls every status into one view with traffic-light statuses. If a row is yellow or red, click into it to see what's missing + the regulatory cite. Audit-export bundles all 12 documents into a single PDF per driver.